
Fw: Legislative Agenda Request: Student Representative Stipend Resolution

From ASRCCD Trustee <ASRCCD.Trustee@rccd.edu>

Date Fri 10/24/2025 2:59 PM

To viewpoints <viewpoints@rcc.edu>

 1 attachment (15 KB)

ASRCCD Student Trustee Agenda_Reporting Template.docx;

Gabriel Graves

Umoja / Honors / M.E.S.A Student

Lead Fellow - **College Corps**

Intern - **Community Action Leadership Academy (CALA)**

Student Trustee - **Riverside Community College District (RCCD)**



From: ASRCCD Trustee <ASRCCD.Trustee@rccd.edu>

Sent: Sunday, September 14, 2025 7:33 PM

To: Bottoms, Megan <Megan.Bottoms@rcc.edu>; Cruz-Soto, Thomas <Thomas.Cruz-Soto@rcc.edu>

Cc: Moore, Frankie <Frankie.Moore@mvc.edu>; Romero, Edwin <Edwin.Romero@norcocollege.edu>; Carter, FeRita <FeRita.Carter@rcc.edu>; Bishop, Eric <Eric.Bishop@rcc.edu>; Dobyys, Keith <Keith.Dobyys@rccd.edu>

Subject: Re: Legislative Agenda Request: Student Representative Stipend Resolution

Dear Megan,

Thank you for your message and for bringing this discussion back to the Coordinators' attention. I appreciate the willingness to plan together, and I am glad to outline the priorities I see for the coming year.

Before sharing those priorities, I want to be transparent about the challenge that has brought us to this point. Over the past month I have struggled to carry out the duties of the Student Trustee because some basic governance requirements—such as the timely posting of agendas and minutes and consistent professional decorum within our governance structure—have not been applied consistently. This is not only a procedural issue; it has affected my own well-being and has limited the kind of collaboration that our students deserve.

I value the unique approaches of each Associated Students organization and do not wish to override their autonomy. At the same time, the ASRCC Constitution specifically charges the Student Trustee with coordinating district-wide efforts and assigns the ASRCC President the duty to support those efforts. To represent all RCCD students effectively, we need a shared commitment to transparency and to the rules that govern us all.

With that understanding, I am happy to share the attached draft agenda of district-wide priorities. These are not meant to replace campus initiatives; they provide a framework for collective work. My own style of governance places as much weight on elevating the concerns of others as on advancing my personal initiatives. The most meaningful part of this role, in my view, is helping every campus bring forward its own priorities while we work together on common goals.

I hope this gives the Coordinators a clear picture of where I would like to see us collaborate, and I welcome feedback on how we can weave campus projects and this district-wide plan together. I am also eager to meet with the Coordinators next week to discuss how we can ensure consistent compliance with our bylaws and with the Brown Act so that all student voices are protected.

Thank you for your attention and for your partnership as we move forward.

Respectfully,

Gabriel Graves

Umoja / Honors / M.E.S.A Student

Lead Fellow - **College Corps**

Intern - **Community Action Leadership Academy (CALA)**

Student Trustee - **Riverside Community College District (RCCD)**



From: Bottoms, Megan <Megan.Bottoms@rcc.edu>

Sent: Thursday, September 11, 2025 3:42 PM

To: ASRCCD Trustee <ASRCCD.Trustee@rccd.edu>; Cruz-Soto, Thomas <Thomas.Cruz-Soto@rcc.edu>

Cc: Moore, Frankie <Frankie.Moore@mvc.edu>; Romero, Edwin <Edwin.Romero@norcocollege.edu>; Carter, FeRita <FeRita.Carter@rcc.edu>; Bishop, Eric <Eric.Bishop@rcc.edu>; Dobyns, Keith <Keith.Dobyns@rccd.edu>

Subject: Re: Legislative Agenda Request: Student Representative Stipend Resolution

Trustee Graves, thanks so much for your email and bringing this to back our attention.

I will work with the other Coordinators at our meeting next week to get a plan how we can coordinate with our teams moving forward. One thing that would be helpful for us if you could give us an idea of your agenda and priorities as the Student Trustee for the year ahead. Each campus has their own unique approach to their governance and so if we have an idea of the initiatives that you would like to prioritize, and a timeline for each, the Coordinators can work with their respective AS to get the work done on each of our campus. I'm sure that you remember from your time last year as a Senator that each AS has their own initiatives and projects they want to complete and so making sure that the projects are working in tandem and not in competition, often gets a larger buy in.

As far as reports, if you'll provide a template and timeline for how you would like communication from the AS Presidents for your report to the Chancellor and Trustees, the Coordinators can pass that information along to the Presidents. This will help in ensure that the information you would like and need is included in a timely manner.

Megan

Megan Bottoms, Ed.D

Associate Professor/Coordinator
Office of Student Life and Leadership
Riverside City College

[Schedule an appointment](#)

From: ASRCCD Trustee <ASRCCD.Trustee@rccd.edu>
Date: Wednesday, September 10, 2025 at 5:19 PM
To: Cruz-Soto, Thomas <Thomas.Cruz-Soto@rcc.edu>
Cc: Bottoms, Megan <Megan.Bottoms@rcc.edu>, Moore, Frankie <Frankie.Moore@mvc.edu>, Romero, Edwin <Edwin.Romero@norcocollege.edu>
Subject: Re: Legislative Agenda Request: Student Representative Stipend Resolution

Dear Dr. Cruz-Soto and Dr. Bottoms,

I want to follow up on my earlier email regarding the need for a resolution meeting about ASRCC governance concerns. While I previously highlighted issues of Brown Act noncompliance, it has become clear that the larger issue is structural: **ASRCC leadership is not operating in alignment with their Constitution and bylaws, which directly obstructs my ability to fulfill my role as Student Trustee.**

Specifically:

- Bylaws Chapter 1 & 8 require that agendas be posted 24 hours before meetings and minutes be published within 72 hours. These requirements are routinely not met.
- The ASRCC Constitution (Article II, Section 6.9) explicitly requires the ASRCC President to “fulfill any duties assigned to them by the RCCD Student Trustee as well as give continual updates regarding RCC activities.” My reasonable requests to the ASRCC President and Vice President have been denied outright.
- I have also been informed by ASRCC Senators that their ability to place agenda items has been restricted by leadership, which undermines both Brown Act compliance and student representation.

As the Student Trustee, my constitutional role is to coordinate across the district, ensure compliance with governance standards, and amplify student voices. When bylaws and constitutional provisions are ignored or selectively enforced, the ability of student government to operate democratically and transparently is compromised — and it places me in a position where I cannot perform my duties effectively.

I want to reiterate my willingness to meet in good faith to resolve these concerns collaboratively. If no meeting is scheduled soon, I will be obligated to escalate this matter to the Chancellor’s Office and, if necessary, to the Board of Trustees as part of my reporting responsibilities.

Please advise on your earliest availability for this resolution meeting.

Respectfully,

Gabriel Graves

Umoja / Honors / M.E.S.A / La Casa Student

Lead Fellow - **College Corps**

Intern - **Community Action Leadership Academy (CALA)**

Student Trustee - **Associated Students of Riverside Community College District (ASRCCD)**

RCCD | RIVERSIDE COMMUNITY
COLLEGE DISTRICT

MORENO VALLEY COLLEGE | NORCO COLLEGE | RIVERSIDE CITY COLLEGE

From: ASRCCD Trustee <ASRCCD.Trustee@rccd.edu>
Sent: Tuesday, August 19, 2025 2:36:59 PM
To: Cruz-Soto, Thomas <Thomas.Cruz-Soto@rcc.edu>; PRES, ASRCC <ASRCC.PRES@rcc.edu>
Cc: Bottoms, Megan <Megan.Bottoms@rcc.edu>; Moore, Frankie <Frankie.Moore@mvc.edu>; Romero, Edwin

<Edwin.Romero@norcollege.edu>; VP, ASRCC <ASRCC.VP@rcc.edu>

Subject: Re: Legislative Agenda Request: Student Representative Stipend Resolution

Thank you, Dr. Cruz-Soto and Dr. Bottoms, I'm open to scheduling this meeting to resolve the issue I have time this week after 2pm.

Gabriel Graves

Umoja / Honors / M.E.S.A Student

Lead Fellow - **College Corps**

Intern - **Community Action Leadership Academy (CALA)**

Student Trustee - **Riverside Community College District (RCCD)**

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COLLEGE DISTRICT



From: Cruz-Soto, Thomas <Thomas.Cruz-Soto@rcc.edu>

Sent: Tuesday, August 19, 2025 2:34 PM

To: ASRCCD Trustee <ASRCCD.Trustee@rccd.edu>; PRES, ASRCC <ASRCC.PRES@rcc.edu>; Graves, Gabriel <ggraves1@student.rccd.edu>

Cc: Bottoms, Megan <Megan.Bottoms@rcc.edu>; Moore, Frankie <Frankie.Moore@mvc.edu>; Romero, Edwin <Edwin.Romero@norcollege.edu>; VP, ASRCC <ASRCC.VP@rcc.edu>; Carter, FeRita <FeRita.Carter@rcc.edu>

Subject: Re: Legislative Agenda Request: Student Representative Stipend Resolution

Dear All,

This conversation should be taken offline and communicated in good faith in person. I understand the importance of email and having receipts, but this is not the way we want to represent ourselves as a college or district with our student leaders.

I asked that the faculty coordinators provide moderation and guidance here and that Dr. Bottoms take the lead in bringing this to a resolution that is functional and productive for all involved.

This is the start of the academic year; there is no time for dysfunction.

Happy to assist where appropriate.

-TCS

Thomas A. Cruz-Soto, Jr., Ed.D.
Dean of Student Services – Riverside City College
Charles A. Kane Student Services and Administration Building
Room 201-B
4800 Magnolia Avenue
Riverside, California 92506
(951)222-8073 (Office)
(951)328-3769 (Fax)



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From: ASRCCD Trustee <ASRCCD.Trustee@rccd.edu>

Date: Tuesday, August 19, 2025 at 2:22 PM

To: PRES, ASRCC <ASRCC.PRES@rcc.edu>, Graves, Gabriel <ggraves1@student.rccd.edu>

Cc: Bottoms, Megan <Megan.Bottoms@rcc.edu>, Cruz-Soto, Thomas <Thomas.Cruz-Soto@rcc.edu>, Moore, Frankie <Frankie.Moore@mvc.edu>, Romero, Edwin <Edwin.Romero@norcocollege.edu>, VP, ASRCC <ASRCC.VP@rcc.edu>, Carter, FeRita <FeRita.Carter@rcc.edu>

Subject: Re: Legislative Agenda Request: Student Representative Stipend Resolution

While I respect your position and authority in the ASRCC I reject the notion that you speak for the entirety of the body and especially not the Senate who is the body with the authority to deny or approve legislative matters.

I'm doing what I can to establish communication and collaboration with you and the rest of the ASRCCD, but I've encountered more resistance from you in organizing and concentrating our efforts than any other AS across the district.

I respect that you want to prioritize the duties and responsibilities of ASRCC, but that includes considering the needs of the rest of the district. I contacted the Senate team and Secretary for the appropriate documents.

If the committees have yet to be structured, then I'm not sure how the board is making decisions about legislative initiatives. **If you are asking me and the rest of the public to follow the policies laid out in your by-laws but not following them yourselves then there is an issue of integrity within the leadership team.**

I want to collaborate and be able to address the issues of all the students of the district. I've been nothing but professional, and **I'm asking for documents that should already be published per ASRCC Executive By-laws Chapter 1 & 8 Articles 2 & 1 respectively,**

- "Minutes of the Executive Cabinet and Committees/Councils shall be posted to the website within 72 hours of the meeting conclusion"
- "Agendas should be posted to the website 24 hours in advance of the meeting"

Additionally, as the ASRCC President **you are compelled by the ASRCC Constitution Article 2 Section 6.9 to "Fulfill any duties assigned to them by the RCCD Student Trustee as well as give continual updates regarding RCC activities."**

I want to be able to continue working together with you to without feeling hostility or feeling alienated because everything that I've asked of you is met with resistance and/or rejected. **This is intended to be a democratic and transparent process but when rules and powers are being wielded inequitably, then there becomes integrity issues.**

This will be my warning before I recommend you, and other ASRCC leadership members for disciplinary action for violations of by-laws policy and neglect of duties as outlined by the ASRCC Constitution and respective by-laws policies.

I want to work with you effectively, and I'm positioned to be able to streamline and amplify the efforts of the entire ASRCCD body. **Please, acknowledge and comply with my request for documentation within 72 hours**, so I can ensure that I'm able to support you as well as all of the other constituents that we serve across the district.

Thank you,

Gabriel Graves

Umoja / Honors / M.E.S.A Student

Lead Fellow - **College Corps**

Intern - **Community Action Leadership Academy (CALA)**

Student Trustee - **Riverside Community College District (RCCD)**



From: PRES, ASRCC <ASRCC.PRES@rcc.edu>

Sent: Tuesday, August 19, 2025 12:56 PM

To: ASRCCD Trustee <ASRCCD.Trustee@rccd.edu>; Graves, Gabriel <ggraves1@student.rccd.edu>

Cc: Bottoms, Megan <Megan.Bottoms@rcc.edu>; Cruz-Soto, Thomas <Thomas.Cruz-Soto@rcc.edu>; Moore, Frankie <Frankie.Moore@mvc.edu>; Romero, Edwin <Edwin.Romero@norcocollege.edu>; VP, ASRCC <ASRCC.VP@rcc.edu>

Subject: Re: Legislative Agenda Request: Student Representative Stipend Resolution

Hi Trustee Graves,

You're welcome and happy to give feedback anytime ! Thank you for your message and for sharing your concerns. As I've mentioned in our previous meeting, ASRCC does not operate in a vacuum. Our vision is inclusive not only of Norco and MVC but also of our entire region. The foundation we are laying at RCC is with the understanding that collaboration across our district is essential.

At the same time, I must also reflect the current work and direction of ASRCC. Right now, our government has been focused on getting organized, trained, and situated so that we can operate effectively. Within the last couple of weeks, we have appointed directors and an executive secretary who is now being trained and will be responsible for taking minutes and managing records. For our required summer meetings, I recorded the minutes myself until this transition could take place. Our first Senate meeting is scheduled for September 2, 2025, after the school year resumes. Once our systems are in place, we will be better positioned to address needs beyond the immediate.

Regarding your email, I'm not sure which team you contacted, as I did not receive any messages regarding the minutes.

I also want to note that you are requesting to be added to a legislative agenda, but the first Senate meeting of the year has not yet taken place, and the senators have not had the opportunity to determine committee assignments. It would be greatly appreciated if you would allow us to complete our initial organization so that we can properly assist you with the items you need in the future. While I wish I had the time to provide a step-by-step play of what we are doing daily, time does not permit; however, you will have access to the information you need when it is made available.

As for your resolution, ASRCC has chosen not to sponsor it at this time, as we have developed a resolution that reflects student government priorities. You are well aware of what we were planning because you attended the Senate meeting where I introduced the stipends proposal to the Senate. That said, if you would like to draft a resolution specifically regarding the district providing a direct typing or resource to the Student Trustee, I think that is a very creative idea and worth exploring on your end.

We remain committed to transparency, inclusivity, and collaboration, but also to ensuring that our student government is firmly grounded before taking on additional initiatives.

Kind regards,

Myisha Jackson

President, ASRCC

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From: ASRCCD Trustee <ASRCCD.Trustee@rccd.edu>

Sent: Tuesday, August 19, 2025 12:28:59 PM

To: PRES, ASRCC <ASRCC.PRES@rcc.edu>; Graves, Gabriel <ggraves1@student.rccd.edu>

Cc: Bottoms, Megan <Megan.Bottoms@rcc.edu>; Cruz-Soto, Thomas <Thomas.Cruz-Soto@rcc.edu>; Moore, Frankie <Frankie.Moore@mvc.edu>; Romero, Edwin <Edwin.Romero@norcocollege.edu>

Subject: Re: Legislative Agenda Request: Student Representative Stipend Resolution

Thank you for your feedback, President Jackson. I'm happy that the ASRCC Senate has been working diligently on this issue, though I want to be sure to remind you that ASRCC doesn't operate in a vacuum.

The students at Norco and MVC also play a role in the student success and enrollment at RCC. There are students who are contributing to ASRCC funds are attending our sister campuses but have designated RCC as their home campus. Furthermore, Norco and MVC are prospering, and help in attracting students into our district — which also adds to the available resources to the RCC campus and population as well.

I appreciate that you are willing to review the documents that I've provided, and I trust that you have the students' best interests at heart. As we continue forward through this year, It will be absolutely essential for my team to organize initiatives across the district. This requires adequate communication, and access to public documents and records. There is a lack of transparency with publishing agendas and minutes within the ASRCC which is leaving us guessing without a way to accurately gauge what ASRCC is doing. Again, thank you for expressing your sentiment of solidarity. I know that as we proceed with the year, I will need to lean on you for support.

I emailed your team this morning requesting the documentation for the actions and meetings that have transpired since the beginning of our terms. Please have them send them to me in a timely manner so I can review them. Also, please include me in your email lists for events and meetings so I can ensure the Student Trustee will have representation and be able to advise you all from the perspective of the interests of our students across the district.

Thank you,

Gabriel Graves

Umoja / Honors / M.E.S.A Student

Lead Fellow - **College Corps**

Intern - **Community Action Leadership Academy (CALA)**

Student Trustee - **Riverside Community College District (RCCD)**



From: PRES, ASRCC <ASRCC.PRES@rcc.edu>

Sent: Tuesday, August 19, 2025 2:10 AM

To: ASRCCD Trustee <ASRCCD.Trustee@rccd.edu>; Graves, Gabriel <ggraves1@student.rccd.edu>

Cc: Bottoms, Megan <Megan.Bottoms@rcc.edu>; Cruz-Soto, Thomas <Thomas.Cruz-Soto@rcc.edu>; Moore, Frankie <Frankie.Moore@mvc.edu>; Romero, Edwin <Edwin.Romero@norcocollege.edu>

Subject: Re: Legislative Agenda Request: Student Representative Stipend Resolution

Hello Trustee Graves,

Thank you for sharing your resolution and for the time, research, and dedication you've put into advocating for equitable student participation across our district. Your efforts to highlight the importance of stipends for underrepresented voices are appreciated, and I recognize the value in building a unified approach to strengthen our advocacy at the board level.

At Riverside City College, our Associated Students have already engaged in thorough discussions and reached an agreement on what is viable for our members in terms of time, commitment, and resources. We have developed and proposed a resolution that reflects the needs and circumstances of our campus, and after careful deliberation, we feel this framework works best for us at this time.

That being said, we are open to continued collaboration and conversation as this movement progresses districtwide. We also appreciate your willingness to present your findings, and while our body has already finalized our approach, we will gladly review any supplemental information you provide to ensure that our decisions remain data-informed and considerate of diverse perspectives.

Thank you again for including us in this important conversation.

In solidarity,

Myisha Jackson

President, Associated Students of Riverside City College (ASRCC)

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From: ASRCCD Trustee <ASRCCD.Trustee@rccd.edu>

Sent: Monday, August 18, 2025 10:36:10 PM

To: Graves, Gabriel <ggraves1@student.rccd.edu>

Cc: Bottoms, Megan <Megan.Bottoms@rcc.edu>; Cruz-Soto, Thomas <Thomas.Cruz-Soto@rcc.edu>; Moore, Frankie <Frankie.Moore@mvc.edu>; Romero, Edwin <Edwin.Romero@norcocollege.edu>

Subject: Legislative Agenda Request: Student Representative Stipend Resolution

Hello Presidents, I'm aware of the movement in our district to create a more equitable working environment for our Associated Student members.

Thus, I have drafted a resolution to sponsor student stipends to ensure that underrepresented voices can participate without undue financial hardship. Please, bring this resolution to the legislative floor for debate, discussion, and action to ensure that we are unified in our efforts to increase engagement and incentivize student participation. I will include my sources that are cited so that they can also be added to your respective legislating bodies for your campuses.

I hope to be able to educate our leaders and ensure that they can make rational, and data driven decisions. Thus, I would also like to come and present my findings during your meetings. Please provide me with the meeting schedule for your regular (or committee) legislative meetings so that I can attend (or send a representative in my stead).

Again, I realize that there is already momentum growing in support of student representative stipends which is why I want your legislatures to sponsor this resolution. When we show a unified district wide effort, we can garner more support at the board level.

I've also created a survey that our students can use to give their opinions on the matter.

<https://forms.office.com/r/rHJWN4v0GG>

Please help me gather student opinions as we enter into this semester and get started with our business.

Best,

Gabriel Graves

Umoja / Honors / M.E.S.A Student

Lead Fellow - **College Corps**

Intern - **Community Action Leadership Academy (CALA)**

Student Trustee - **Riverside Community College District (RCCD)**

